

Tanaka Makoni

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EDUCATION

Davidson College

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

Davidson, NC

Expected May 2028

- **Coursework:** NLP & LLM, Machine Reasoning, Software Design, Game Development, Linear Algebra, Database Systems
- **Awards:** Belk Merit Scholarship, Chidsey Fellow, Hack@Davidson 2025 "Best AI Chat Tool", Bernard Society of Mathematics

SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** Python, Java, SQL, Javascript, C#, Swift/SwiftUI, React, Typescript, Svelte, Node.js, Tableau, FastAPI, Ruby, Go, GraphQL
- **Technologies:** Docker, MongoDB, SQL, Git, Django, LangChain, Figma, Tensorflow, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, Matplotlib, Linux,

WORK EXPERIENCE

Strava

iOS Software Engineering Intern, Achieve Team

San Francisco, CA

May 2026 - Present

- Migrated Strava's Apple Watch widgets to WidgetKit, architecting a shared iOS approach for App Attestation and mitigating associated token refresh risks
- Developed iOS features for Strava's Achieve team, contributing to athlete progress, goal-setting, and achievement-related product experiences in Swift/SwiftUI

The Jay Hurt Hub for Innovation and Entrepreneurship, Davidson College

Student Consultant

Davidson, NC

May 2025 - Present

- Built automated payout and transaction logging workflow using n8n and Zapier, integrating Forest Systems, Bill.com and Excel
- Developed Bookniche, a React Native mobile app for book discovery and recommendations, implementing reusable UI components, navigation flows, and client-side state management

Algorithms for Learning in Physics Applications (ALPhA) Lab

Undergraduate Researcher

Davidson, NC

May 2025 - July 2025

- Enhanced understanding of latent space representations in TPCNet, a self-supervised deep learning model based on PointNet, to capture key features of 3D point cloud data from the Active-Target Time Projection Chamber (AT-TPC)
- Applied ML techniques including linear/logistic regression, support vector machines (SVM), and clustering (K-means and t-SNE)

PROJECTS

Sera | [View](#)

Charlotte, NC

- Built a full-stack iOS skincare companion app using SwiftUI, SwiftData, Supabase, and a Node.js/Express backend, powering routine tracking, AI diagnostics, social features, and personalized product suggestions
- Engineered an AI skin analysis pipeline with the OpenAI GPT-4o vision API and a Supabase Postgres-backed social graph, supporting structured concern assessments and authenticated follow/post/like activity feeds from the Swift client

Global Desk | [View](#)

Charlotte, NC

- Built full-stack RAG assistant with FastAPI, LangChain, OpenAI, and ChromaDB to answer international student policy questions
- Engineered the end-to-end RAG pipeline, including ingestion, chunking, embeddings, semantic retrieval, source handling, admin document management, and evaluation.

Course Review Aggregator

Charlotte, NC

- Built automated ETL pipelines to ingest and transform professor data into structured JSON datasets for analytics and search
- Engineered a Selenium + BeautifulSoup pipeline to extract, clean, and store ratings, tags, and review JSON data

LEADERSHIP AND INVOLVEMENT

Hack@Davidson

President

Davidson, NC

October 2024 - Present

- Secured and managed sponsorships from leading tech companies in the greater Charlotte area, raising \$10,000+ in funding to support event logistics, prizes, and participant engagement
- Coordinated with sponsors to promote their brand through event materials, social media, and virtual booths, increasing sponsor visibility and engagement by 25%

Davidson Entrepreneurship Club

Social Media & Marketing Lead

Davidson, NC

April 2025 - Present

- Drive marketing strategy and content creation on Instagram and LinkedIn, boosting engagement and broadening reach across academic departments and helping secure \$20,000 in funding
- Organized Davidson's 2025 Techstars Startup Weekend, raising \$5,000+ in sponsorships and engaging 35+ participants in a 54-hour entrepreneurial event

Chidsey Leadership Fellows

Special Events Committee

Davidson, NC

Aug 2025 - Present

- Selected as one of 16 students (from 100+ applicants) for three-year leadership development training focused on ethical, community oriented leadership
- Engage in experiential curriculum including leadership dialogues, coaching sessions, and a \$2,500 summer immersion experience.